

Company Internal Policy – Remote Work and Data Security

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Effective Date: February 1, 2026

Approved by: Chief Operations Officer

1. Purpose

This policy defines the rules and procedures for employees working remotely, including requirements for securing company data, devices, and communication channels. It aims to maintain operational efficiency, ensure data security, and clarify responsibilities.

2. Scope

Applicable to all employees, contractors, and interns with remote work privileges. This includes:

- Full-time and part-time employees
 - Temporary project contractors
 - Interns assigned to remote work
 - Employees on hybrid schedules
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3. Policy Details

3.1 Remote Work Eligibility

- Employees must have completed a minimum of **3 months on-site** before eligibility.
- Approval is required from both the direct manager and the HR department.
- Temporary remote work (less than 1 week) may be granted without formal approval.
- Exceptions may be granted for health, travel, or personal emergencies.

Example:

Employee John Doe has completed 4 months on-site. He submits a request for a 2-week remote assignment. Manager approval + HR confirmation required.

3.2 Data Security Requirements

- All company data must be stored on **company-approved cloud services**.
- Local storage on personal devices is strictly prohibited.
- VPN use is mandatory for accessing internal systems.
- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) must be enabled for all accounts.
- Passwords must be updated every **90 days**.
- Confidential files must be encrypted before transfer.

Example:

When sending project files to a client, employees must use encrypted email or approved file-sharing platforms.

3.3 Device Requirements

- Company-provided laptops are preferred; personal devices may be used only if approved.
 - Personal devices must have updated endpoint protection and encryption enabled.
 - Anti-virus software must be updated **weekly**.
 - All devices must be locked when unattended.
 - Remote access devices must be registered with the IT department.
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3.4 Communication and Reporting

- Daily check-ins via internal messaging platforms (e.g., Teams, Slack) are mandatory.
 - Weekly status reports must be submitted every Friday by 5 PM.
 - Security incidents must be reported to IT within **24 hours**.
 - Employees must complete annual **cybersecurity awareness training**.
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3.5 Work Hours and Availability

- Standard remote work hours: **9:00 AM – 5:00 PM**, local time.

- Employees may request flexible hours with manager approval.
 - Employees must be reachable via company email or chat during working hours.
 - Out-of-office exceptions must be communicated **48 hours in advance**.
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3.6 Meetings and Collaboration

- Video calls are required for weekly team meetings.
 - Screen sharing is encouraged for collaborative work sessions.
 - All meeting recordings must be stored on company-approved platforms.
 - Meeting notes must be uploaded to the internal project tracker within 24 hours.
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3.7 Software and Tools

- Only company-approved tools may be used for work purposes.
 - Software updates must be installed promptly.
 - Employees may not install unlicensed software.
 - Collaboration tools must be configured to prevent unauthorized access.
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3.8 Security Audits and Monitoring

- The IT department will conduct quarterly audits of remote devices.
 - Random checks may be performed to ensure compliance.
 - Audit results will be reported to the department head.
 - Employees must cooperate during audits and provide requested documentation.
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3.9 Confidentiality and Intellectual Property

- Employees must not disclose company secrets or client information.
 - Intellectual property created during remote work remains property of the company.
 - Breach of confidentiality may result in disciplinary action or termination.
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3.10 Violations and Consequences

- Minor violations: warning + mandatory retraining.
- Major violations: suspension of remote work privileges.
- Severe violations: possible termination.

Example:

Leaving a laptop unattended in a public place while logged into company systems constitutes a major violation.

3.11 Exceptions and Special Cases

- Requests for exceptions must be submitted to HR in writing.
 - Exceptions must be approved by the manager and IT.
 - Emergency remote work situations may be temporarily approved by department head.
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4. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Managers	Ensure team members are aware of and comply with this policy; approve remote requests.
Employees	Follow guidelines, report incidents, attend required training.
IT Department	Provide support, conduct audits, ensure security compliance.
HR Department	Maintain records of remote work approvals; handle exceptions.

5. Training and Awareness

- All employees must complete mandatory cybersecurity and remote work training **annually**.
 - Additional optional workshops are offered quarterly on topics such as secure file sharing, endpoint protection, and remote collaboration tools.
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6. Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	Feb 1, 2026	Initial release
1.1	Feb 7, 2026	Updated device requirements
1.2	Feb 10, 2026	Added section on work hours and collaboration

7. References

- Company IT Security Manual
- Employee Handbook 2025 Edition
- Remote Work Guidelines (Internal Memo, 2025)